- ***Group information sharing over long distances.*** Although friends and family members can keep in contact via mobile phone calls or by text messages, social nets provide a much richer environment for staying connected. We can also share photo albums, videos and convey daily wishes through the social network. Group discussions and Group chats go on in various groups through which people are kept in touch with each other.
- ***Broadcast announcements.*** Quick, easy way to spread informations of emergencies and natural calamities. Venues and local shops can advertise upcoming events on social networks. Business people can market their products through these networks.
- ***Fostering diversity of thought.*** Some critics of social networks say that online communities attract people by similar interests and backgrounds. Indeed, when the people with different opinions do get together on online, many discussions seem to degenerate into personal attacks and so-called **"flame wars."** The arguments goes online, healthy debate takes place and some of them become viral also.

Such arguments and talks bring out a relaxation for busy people from their regular work schedules. It also enriches with current affairs and keep in touch with people.

POINTS TO REMEMBER

- A set of computers connected together for the purpose of sharing resources is called as computer network. Internet is the most common resource shared on today.
- Computer networking is a technique of digital telecommunication network that permits nodes to share its resources with one another. Computer networking exchanges the data as a main element. These link were transferred over cable media like optic cables or wire or wireless media such as Bluetooth and WIFI
- Packet switching is a method of grouping data that is transmitted over a digital network into packets.
- In 1966 WAN (WIDE AREA NETWORK)was introduced for time sharing.
- Artificial intelligence helps to predict traffic as it collects and analyzes data in real time.
- The common uses of computer networks were
    - Communication
    - Resource Sharing
    - Data (or) software sharing
    - Money savings
- Networks at home were connected by two ways they are
    - Wired network
    - Wireless network
- When group of people of different opinion come together online, many discussions arise which lead to personal attacks called **"flame wars."**

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